

Art and Creative Education – I

An exhaustive academic monograph investigating the psychological and sensory foundations of artistic development, creative writing pedagogy, observational outdoor sketching, still life geometry, stencil mechanics, indigenous toy craft under NEP 2020 Toy Pedagogy, tactile clay sculpture, the Neo-Vaishnavite cultural renaissance of Assam (Srimanta Sankardeva, Sri Sri Madhabdeva, Namghars, Borgeet, Sattriya Nritya, Bhaona, Majuli mask craft, and Sachipat manuscript illumination), John Berger's critical visual literacy (*Ways of Seeing*), Fine Arts vs. Applied Folk Crafts, the Seven Elements of Visual Art and Principles of Composition, Elliot Eisner's educational aesthetic values, rural livelihood crafts in Assam (Muga/Eri sericulture, bamboo fabrication, Sarthebari bell-metal, Asharikandi terracotta), legendary Indian and Western master artists (Raja Ravi Varma, Abanindranath Tagore, Jamini Roy, Nandalal Bose, Sobha Brahma, Leonardo da Vinci, Vincent van Gogh, Pablo Picasso), five monumental architectural heritage sites (Ajanta, Ellora, Khajuraho, Madan Kamdev, Da-Parbatia doorframe), and the continuous 30-mark Practicum framework featuring BALA (Building as Learning Aid) classroom installations.

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● Curriculum Session 2026 • Exhaustive Master Reference Edition

SYLLABUS ARCHITECTURE & MODULE WEIGHTAGE

Total: 20 External Marks

Unit 1

10 Marks

Development of Skill

Creative Writing, Observational Sketching, Drawing from Nature, Still Life, Stencils, Toy Pedagogy, Collage, Clay Craft.

Unit 2

5 Marks

History & Theory of Art

Sattriya Renaissance, Borgeet, Bhaona, Sachipat Art, John Berger's Ways of Seeing, 7 Elements, Aesthetics & Livelihood in Assam.

Unit 3

5 Marks

Masters & Monuments

Indian & Western Pioneers (Ravi Varma, Abanindranath, Sobha Brahma, Da Vinci, Van Gogh, Picasso), Ajanta, Ellora, Khajuraho, Madan Kamdev, Da-Parbatia.

1

Development of Expressive & Creative Skills

Creative Writing, Observational Outdoor Drawing, Still Life, Stenciling, Indigenous Toy Craft & Tactile Clay Modeling

Weightage:
10 Marks

In foundational teacher education, **Creative Expression** is not restricted to applying pigment to canvas; literary and theatrical composition represent co-equal aesthetic disciplines. Creative writing acts as an emotional catharsis, allowing children to externalize inner anxieties, process sensory memories, and develop narrative empathy. When children articulate their personal worlds through prose and poetry, written language transitions from a mechanical test requirement into an instrument of personal empowerment:

● 1. SENSORY MEMORY ESSAYS

Guiding children to reconstruct vivid sensory recollections: the fragrance of wet paddy soil after the first monsoon shower (*Petrichor*), the fear of shadows in twilight bamboo groves, or the bustling sounds of a village weekly *Haat*. Teaches emotional authenticity and sensory adjectives.

Focus: Sensory Perception

● 2. VERSE & RHYME CRAFTING

Composing rhythmic couplets, nonsense limericks, and indigenous animal rhymes. Children explore acoustic alliteration, onomatopoeia, and metaphorical imagery, developing an intuitive ear for language rhythm and phonological prosody.

Focus: Phonological Rhythm

● 3. ROLE-PLAY SCRIPTWRITING

Authoring dramatic dialogues for cloth glove-puppets, shadow plays, and environmental skits. Cultivates character perspective-taking, conflict-and-resolution sequencing, and conversational pacing free from rote textbook recitation.

Focus: Socio-Dramatic Dialogue

● 4. CLASSROOM JOURNALISM

Drafting daily school wall-magazine notices, weather bulletins, and factual reports of campus tree plantations or sports triumphs. Synthesizes objective observation with lively editorial reportage for peer reading.

Focus: Civic Communication

1.2 Outdoor Sketching, Drawing from Nature & Still Life Geometry

Perceptual Acuity

Drawing is not merely a fine-motor technical skill; it is a profound cognitive methodology of *thinking with the eye and hand*. Traditional rote teaching forces young children to mechanically copy flat, two-dimensional line outlines from a blackboard. Authentic visual education takes the learner out into the physical landscape to observe natural volume, spatial distance, and shifting daylight directly:

● OUTDOOR STUDIES & DRAWING FROM NATURE (প্রকৃতি পর্যবেক্ষণ)

The primary school courtyard and surrounding village serve as a living studio:

- **Botanical Precision:** Closely studying the branching angles of local bamboo, the serrated margins of betel leaves, the rough fissures of tree bark, and seed geometries.
- **Natural Horizon & Spatial Receding:** Understanding that distant trees appear paler, hazier, and smaller due to atmospheric perspective, establishing three-dimensional depth on a two-dimensional paper surface.
- **Visual Memory Training:** Challenging learners to observe a flying egret or village pond for 60 seconds, closing their eyes to retain the mental image, and drawing the dynamic gesture from memory.

● STILL LIFE OBSERVATION & THREE-DIMENSIONAL RENDERING (নিজীব বস্তু চিত্রণ)

Arranging familiar inanimate objects to analyze spatial interplay:

- **Cultural Assemblies:** Grouping traditional brass utensils (*Kahi*, *Bati*, *Lota*), earthen pitchers (*Kalah*), bamboo baskets, and seasonal fruits on a low table.
- **Positive vs. Negative Space:** Training the child's eye to see not just the solid objects (positive space), but the geometric air contours *between* the vessels (negative space).
- **Light, Shadow & Cross-Hatching:** Rendering physical volume through tonal gradation: pinpointing the highlight (where light hits directly), mid-tones, core shadow, and cast shadow.

Drawing from life trains the eye to see truth rather than preconceived clichés!

1.3 &
1.4

Stencil Craft, Indigenous Toy Making, Collage & Tactile Clay Modeling

Tactile
Intelligence

1. STENCIL CRAFT

Cutting geometric cardboard, dried leaves, or thick paper to master positive and negative silhouettes. Applying pigment through dabbing sponges or toothbrushes to create border repeat prints on book covers.

2. INDIGENOUS TOY MAKING

Fabricating kinetic moving toys from discarded bottle caps, bamboo splints, jute twine, and dried seeds under the ****NEP 2020 Toy-Based Pedagogy**** mandate. Converts abstract physics into tactile fun!

3. COLLAGE COMPOSITION

Tearing and assembling varied textures: discarded newsprint, dried tea leaves, sackcloth, and candy wrappers. Explores tactile contrast and environmental recycling without expensive commercial art supplies.

4. CLAY SCULPTURE (মৃৎশিল্প)

Kneading river alluvial clay into geometric spheres, animal figures, and miniature kitchen pots. Calibrates fine-motor digital strength, palm compression, and translates mental ideas into solid three dimensions.

Zero-Cost Classroom Play-Dough Recipe for Trainees:

When natural river clay is inaccessible, student-teachers can prepare safe, non-toxic sensory dough: combine 2 cups wheat flour (*Aata*), $\frac{1}{2}$ cup common salt, 2 tablespoons edible vegetable oil, and warm water. Knead into elastic consistency. Tint with natural vegetable extracts: ground turmeric (*Haldi*) for yellow, spinach water for emerald green, and beetroot boil for deep red. Completely safe, biodegradable, and cost-effective!

History and Theory of Art & The Heritage of Assam

Weightage:
5 Marks

Sattriya Traditions, Ways of Seeing, Seven Elements of Art, Principles of Composition & Rural Livelihood

2.1 &
2.2

Sattriya Culture: The Neo-Vaishnavite Artistic Renaissance of Assam

Cultural
Monument

In the 15th and 16th centuries, **Mahapurush Srimanta Sankardeva (1449–1568 CE)** and his foremost apostolic disciple **Sri Sri Madhabdeva (1489–1596 CE)** spearheaded an extraordinary socio-cultural and egalitarian renaissance in Assam. Recognizing that abstract theological philosophy could not unite a fractured, multi-ethnic society, Sankardeva harnessed the visual, performing, musical, and theatrical arts as sacred vehicles of democratic mass education. The monastic institution of the **Sattr** and the village community **Namghar** became living academies of five interconnected artistic forms:

ARTISTIC FORM	DOCTRINAL AESTHETICS & STRUCTURAL MECHANICS	PRIMARY EDUCATIONAL & CLASSROOM SIGNIFICANCE

1. Borgeet (বৰগীত)	Sublime devotional classical lyrics composed in the literary lingua franca <i>Brajavali</i> , set to intricate classical Indian Ragas and spiritual Talas accompanied by the traditional clay drum (*Khol*) and bronze cymbals (*Taal*).	Cultivates vocal control, auditory sensitivity, emotional serenity, and classical musical appreciation in young learners.
2. Sattriya Nritya (সত্ৰীয়া নৃত্য)	Recognized by Sangeet Natak Akademi as one of India's eight classical dance traditions. Governed by precise hand gestures (*Hastamudras*), footwork (*Mati-Akhara*), and spiritual devotion (*Bhakti Rasa*).	Develops bodily posture, spinal alignment, neuromuscular balance, rhythmic foot precision, and kinetic coordination.
3. Bhaona & Mukha Craft (ভাওনা আৰু মুখাশিল্প)	Traditional community drama (*Ankiya Naat*). Staged with majestic bamboo-and-clay masks (*Mukha* craft, preserved in Majuli sattras like Samaguri), vibrant costumes, and stylized gait.	Engages children in stage performance, dissolves social inhibitions, teaches voice projection, and connects art with folk morality.
4. Sachipat Manuscript Art (সাঁচিপতীয়া চিত্ৰ)	Illuminated miniature paintings rendered on treated bark of the Sachi tree (*Aquilaria agallocha*). Masterpieces like the *Chitra Bhagavata* and *Hastividya* utilized natural botanical and mineral pigments (*Hengul*, *Haital*).	Exemplifies traditional Assamese linear painting, natural plant dye chemistry, and the art of historical book illustration.

2.3 &
2.4

John Berger's "Ways of Seeing" and The Taxonomy of Visual Arts

Critical Visual
Literacy

John Berger's "Ways of Seeing" (দৰ্শনৰ ধাৰণা):

British cultural theorist John Berger revolutionized visual aesthetics with his celebrated dictum: "*Seeing comes before words. The child looks and recognizes before it can speak.*" Berger demonstrated that looking is never a neutral, objective optical act:

- **Conditioned Perception:** We never look at an image in isolation; our gaze is shaped by cultural habits, social status, gender roles, and commercial advertising.
- **The Impact of Mechanical Reproduction:** Modern digital smartphones and printing multiply images endlessly. This strips original masterpieces of their unique historical presence (what Walter Benjamin called the "aura"), reducing art to disposable consumer imagery.
- **Critical Pedagogical Directive:** Teachers must train primary students to decode advertising imagery, digital screens, and television cartoons critically, identifying how visual framing influences desires and consumerist behavior.

Visual Arts vs. Fine Arts vs. Applied Craft:

Contemporary aesthetic theory organizes creative works along functional and contemplative axes:

- **Visual Arts (দৃশ্য কলা):** The overarching umbrella classification encompassing all art forms experienced through sight—painting, sculpture, printmaking, photography, video, digital design, and crafts.
- **Fine Arts (চাৰুকলা):** Historically created solely for intellectual contemplation, emotional transcendence, and aesthetic beauty (canvas painting, classical sculpture, printmaking) without immediate practical utility.
- **Applied & Decorative Arts (কাৰুকলা):** The intentional application of artistic design and ornament to objects of daily utilitarian service (handloom textiles, pottery, cane furniture, bell-metal ware). In elementary school, Fine Arts and Applied Crafts must be unified!

2.5

The Seven Elements of Visual Art & Principles of Composition

Artistic Grammar

Just as verbal language relies on phonemes and syntax, visual expression is constructed through the **Seven Elements of Art**, structured dynamically via the **Principles of Design**:

1. Line (ৰেখা)

Continuous moving point; vertical (dignity), horizontal (calm), diagonal (action), jagged (chaos).

2. Shape (আকাৰ)

Two-dimensional enclosed area (2D); geometric (circles, squares) vs. organic (leaves, clouds).

3. Form (ৰূপ)

Three-dimensional (3D) entity with height, width, and depth (cubes, spheres, clay figurines).

4. Colour (ৰং)

Wavelength reflection; Primary (Red/Yellow/Blue), Secondary, and Complementary pairs.

5. Value (মান)

Lightness or darkness of a hue; creates volume, contrast, and dramatic highlights through shading.

6. Texture (বিন্যাস)

Surface tactile feel (actual vs. visual illusion): rough jute, smooth brass, prickly pineapple skin.

7. Space (স্থান)

Perspective, depth, foreground, middle ground, background, and breathing room between objects.

Principles of Design / Composition (সংযোজনাৰ নীতিসমূহ):

How elements are assembled to generate aesthetic power: (1) **Balance**: Symmetrical (formal peace) vs. Asymmetrical (dynamic energy); (2) **Rhythm & Movement**: Visual repetition guiding the viewer's eye across the page; (3) **Contrast**: Opposing values (dark against bright) creating visual drama; (4) **Emphasis / Focal Point**: The center of interest that commands immediate visual attention; and (5) **Unity & Harmony**: The feeling that all visual elements belong together organically.

2.6 &
2.7

Educational Values of Art & Indigenous Aesthetics for Livelihood in Assam

Applied
Pedagogy

What the Arts Teach: Elliot Eisner's Theory:

Stanford educational theorist Elliot Eisner proved that the arts are not soft, decorative hobbies; they demand complex cognitive operations:

- **Problems Can Have Multiple Solutions**: Unlike standardized multiple-choice exams where only one answer is rewarded, the arts teach that questions can have countless imaginative, valid answers.
- **Nuanced Judgment over Rules**: Art teaches children to make qualitative choices based on subtle gradations of feeling, tone, and balance rather than rigid formulas.
- **The Limits of Verbal Language**: Art proves that not everything humans know, feel, or experience can be translated into words; non-verbal symbols carry profound cognitive weight.

Indigenous Aesthetics as Economic Livelihood in Assam:

In Assam, art has never been an elite luxury; it is deeply interwoven with rural socio-economic survival, self-reliance, and community dignity:

- **Sericulture & Handloom Weaving:** Traditional rearing of *Muga* (golden silk), *Eri* (endandi peace silk), and *Pat* cocoons. Rural women weavers encode ethnic motifs (*Karbi*, *Bodo*, *Mising*, *Assamese*) on handlooms, generating vital family income in Indian Rupees (₹).
- **Bamboo & Cane Industry:** Manufacturing the iconic headgear (*Japi*), fishing basket traps (*Jakoi*, *Polo*, *Chepa*), and household furniture.
- **Sarthebari Bell-Metal (*Kanh-Xilpa*):** Hand-hammered bronze and bell-metal tableware (*Kahi*, *Bati*, *Sarai*), representing centuries of metallurgical heritage.
- **Asharikandi Terracotta (Dhubri):** Red clay pottery, traditional earthen lamps, and ornamental folk figures sustaining generational artisan clusters.

3

Documentation of Art, Legendary Masters & Architectural Monuments

Indian & Western Pioneers, Ancient Rock-Cut Sanctuaries & Architectural Heritage of Assam

Weightage:
5 Marks

● MASTER INDIAN TRAILBLAZERS

Raja Ravi Varma (1848–1906):

The royal master from Travancore who revolutionized Indian visual culture. Fused European academic realism and oil techniques with themes from Hindu epics (*Mahabharata*, *Ramayana*). Established the historic Ghatkoper lithographic press, democratizing sacred imagery across ordinary Indian households through affordable color prints.

Abanindranath Tagore (1871–1951):

Founder of the Bengal School of Art; nephew of Rabindranath Tagore. Strongly rejected European oil materialism, pioneering the Swadeshi art movement through lyrical, misty watercolor wash techniques inspired by Mughal and Ajanta traditions (author of the iconic painting *Bharat Mata*, 1905).

Jamini Roy & Nandalal Bose:

Jamini Roy (1887–1972) rejected Western realism in favor of raw Kalighat folk simplicity and bold Santhal lines. Nandalal Bose (1882–1966), leading Santiniketan's Kala Bhavana, created Haripura Congress posters and illuminated the original calligraphic manuscript of the Constitution of India!

Sobha Brahma (1929–2012):

Assam's foremost modernist master painter and sculptor from Kokrajhar. Blended indigenous tribal folk forms with European modernist cubism, establishing modern visual art education in the Brahmaputra Valley as Principal of the Government College of Arts and Crafts, Guwahati.

● MASTER WESTERN TRAILBLAZERS

Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519):

The supreme Italian Renaissance polymath. Perfected linear perspective, human anatomical precision, and *Sfumato* (subtle smoky transitions between tones without hard outlines). Creator of the world's most celebrated masterpieces: the *Mona Lisa* and *The Last Supper*.

Vincent van Gogh (1853–1890):

The Dutch Post-Impressionist master whose turbulent, passionate life transformed modern expressionism. Pioneered heavy textural brushwork (*Impasto*), swirling dynamic lines, and emotive non-naturalistic colors (*The Starry Night*, *Sunflowers*, *The Bedroom at Arles*).

Pablo Picasso (1881–1973):

The Spanish revolutionary co-founder of **Cubism**. Smashed five centuries of traditional Renaissance perspective by dismantling three-dimensional subjects into geometric planes and presenting them simultaneously from multiple viewpoints (creator of the anti-war mural masterpiece *Guernica*, 1937).

1. AJANTA CAVES (MAHARASHTRA)

UNESCO Site

A crescent-shaped cliff housing 30 rock-cut Buddhist sanctuaries and monasteries dating from 2nd century BCE to 5th century CE. Globally celebrated for ancient *Fresco-Secco* murals depicting Jataka tales with graceful, undulating linear contours, emotive facial expressions, and supple bodily anatomy (e.g., the luminous *Padmapani Bodhisattva* in Cave 1).

The Pinnacle of Ancient Indian Mural Painting

2. ELLORA CAVES (MAHARASHTRA)

Rashtrakuta Era

A massive complex of 34 rock-cut temples representing Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain harmony (600–1000 CE). Contains Cave 16: the world's most astonishing monolithic sculpture—the **Kailash Temple**, excavated entirely top-down from a single basalt mountain cliff with chisels and hammers without structural joints!

Monolithic Kailash Temple (Cave 16)

3. KHAJURAHO (MADHYA PRADESH)

Chandela Dynasty

Built between 950 and 1050 CE, Khajuraho represents the architectural zenith of Nagara-style sandstone temples. Celebrated for intricate sculptural friezes displaying celestial dancers (*Apsaras*), musicians, domestic deities, and celebrated erotic couples (*Mithuna*), symbolizing the cosmic union of energy and consciousness.

Kandariya Mahadeva & Nagara Spires

4. MADAN KAMDEV (BAIHATA CHARIALI, ASSAM)

Kamarupa Pala

Affectionately celebrated as the "*Khajuraho of Assam*". Situated atop Madanguri hill near Baihata Chariali, these 10th–12th century CE archaeological granite ruins of the Kamarupa Pala dynasty feature richly carved temple bases, dancing Ganeshas, mythical griffins, lion gargoyles, and exquisite erotic couples depicting medieval Tantric-Vaishnavite artistic synthesis.

The "Khajuraho of Assam" • Baihata Chariali

5. DA-PARBATIA SANDSTONE DOORFRAME (TEZPUR, ASSAM)

Classical Gupta Art

Located near Tezpur in Sonitpur district, the **Da-Parbatia** temple ruins contain the oldest and most exquisite architectural sculpture in Assam, dating from the classical **Imperial Gupta epoch** (5th-6th century CE):

Iconographic Brilliance:

The doorframe features gracefully posed river goddesses **Ganga** and **Yamuna** standing in elegant **Tribhanga** postures atop blooming lotus petals, holding sacred pitchers with celestial attendants.

Frieze Ornamentation:

The surrounding jambs are intricately embellished with trailing foliage, flying geese (**Hamsas**), garland-bearing **Vidyadharas**, and mythical serpent guardians (**Nagas**), establishing that ancient Assam was intimately connected to the highest classical Indian artistic aesthetic.

Oldest Classical Gupta Sandstone Doorframe in Assam (5th-6th c. CE) • River Goddesses Ganga & Yamuna

PAPER S1.7 CONTINUOUS INTERNAL ASSESSMENT BLUEPRINT

Total: 30 Internal Marks • Practical Studios, Albums, BALA & Field Practice

Session 2026

Workshops &
Studios

10 Marks

Performance in Practical
Arts

Monument Albums

5 Marks

Assam Heritage
Documentation

Institutional Unit Test

5 Marks

Internal Written
Evaluation

SIP-I School Art
Activity

10 Marks

BALA / Wall Magazine /
Dance

PRESCRIBED PRACTICUM ACTIVITY REQUIREMENTS:

- **Outdoor Nature Studies (10 Marks Studio Component):** Complete an outdoor landscape sketchbook capturing natural light, shadow transitions, and color mixing; execute hand-turned clay vessels, leaf-stencils, and waste material collage compositions.
- **Heritage Monument Album Project (5 Marks):** Compile a documented, illustrated monograph tracing the architectural history of Assam's historical monuments (e.g., Da-Parbatia doorframe, Madan Kamdev, Rang Ghar, Talatal Ghar, Kareng Ghar, Shiva Doul).
- **Art & Creative Activity Corner Setup:** Plan and fabricate a child-accessible "Art and Craft Corner" inside an attached primary school containing child-safe clay, natural dyes, scrap paper, and local bamboo tools.

SCHOOL INTERNSHIP (SIP-I LINKAGE - 10 MARKS):

During the 2-week School Internship-I, student-teachers must execute at least two structured creative art interventions with primary school children:

• BALA (Building as Learning Aid):

Designing instructional educational paintings (geometry clocks, number ladders, phonetic trees) directly on primary classroom walls.

• Wall Magazine & Social Awareness Posters:

Compiling children's drawings, folk lullabies, and proverbs into a school wall magazine; organizing poster drives on child safety.

Paper S1.7 Master Study Notes • Curriculum Session 2026

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